

I set the bet size so that we would win about \$100 an hour because I knew they wouldn't stand for much more than that. I just wanted to prove that we could do it. I won about \$100 an hour for six hours. The casino was fine with that, and they thought it was just luck. We came back the second night and again won about \$100 an hour until closing time. Now they were getting less friendly. They put shills on either side of me to watch my every move. Then they got the idea that I was marking the cards. The pit boss and some other people scrutinized the cards, but they couldn't find anything because there was nothing to find.

On the third night, they were friendly again, and asked if I wanted a coffee, which I accepted. I drank the coffee, and then I noticed that I couldn't follow the count. My head felt really funny, and I got up and left, letting my colleagues to do the playing. My colleague's wife was a nurse, and she told me that my pupils were dilated like those of a drug addict. They plied me with coffee and walked me for hours to get me back into shape. The next night we went back, and they offered me coffee again.

Why did you keep going back to the same place?

There were only two places with baccarat in town. I declined the coffee and asked for just a glass of water instead.

Why did you ask for anything? Why didn't you just say you weren't thirsty?

I figured whatever they were using, they would put in the water, and I would be able to tell what it was. I put a drop of water on my tongue, and it tasted like someone had emptied a box of baking soda into it. That drop was enough to put me out again. I left, and they told my colleagues that they didn't want them or me playing there anymore. We had one day left, before heading back, so we went to the other casino. Since it was our last day, I said, "We might as well take the gloves off and play for \$1,000 an hour." We played for two and half hours and made \$2,500.

The owner walked up with one of the largest security guards I have ever seen and said, "We don't want you playing here anymore."

I asked, "Why not?"